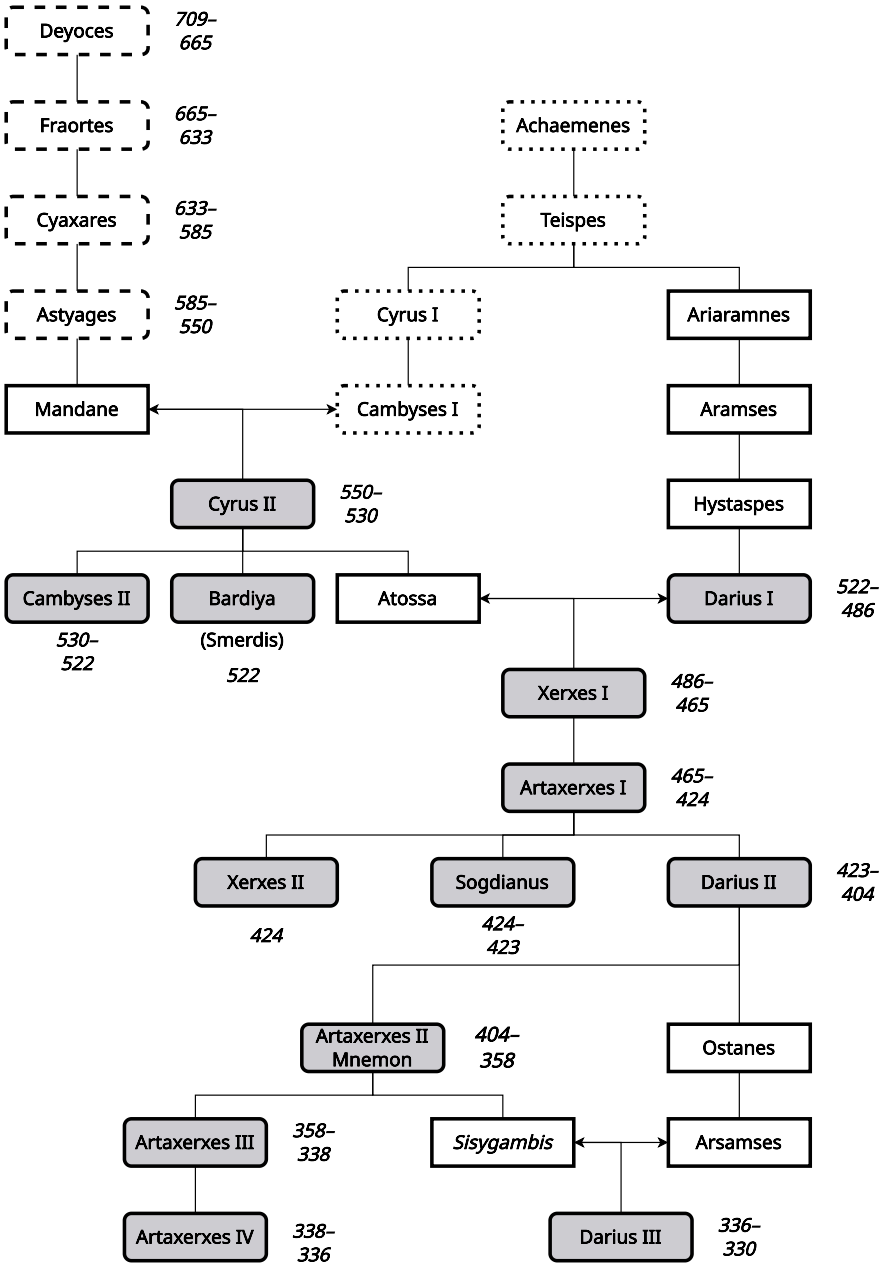
Translation 1: *A, the Great King, King of Kings, King of countries, son of B, an Achaemenian, who built this Palace.*

Note: *Achaemenian* refers to a descendant of Achaemenes.

Grotefend deciphered the above words without deciphering the letters. He could see that the second inscription also mentions two names, let's say, C and D (in that order).

At first, Grotefend was unable to decipher the names - A, B, C and D. However, the family tree of the Achaemenid dynasty gave him enough clues to pin down the names. The tree is shown below. The names follow the modern English spellings that closely reproduce the Greek pronunciations of the Old Persian words. The Achaemenid kings (descendants of Achaemenes who also reigned) are shown in shaded boxes. The reigning periods of all the kings have been shown as well.



Assignment 1: (5 marks)

Translate Niebuhr inscription 2 into English (you can use C and D for the names).

Assignment 2: (7 marks)

Identify A, B, C, and D. Explain how you arrived at your answer.

Assignment 3: (5 marks)

Give the Old Persian cuneiforms for the following English words:

(a) King

(b) Son

(c) Achaemenian

Assignment 4: (3 marks)

What do the following cuneiform symbols stand for:

(a) 

(b) 

(c) 

– Monojit Choudhury

This is the end.